Bringing Animal Performers onto a Rim Bueng Stage: Step-by-Step Guide for Productions

Rim Bueng Studios Co., Ltd., Salaya, Nakhon Pathom · Studio Operations Guide SOG-14, version 2.1 · Issued 15 September 2026

1. Purpose and scope

This guide explains what a production must do, step by step, when it wants to film live animals at Rim Bueng Studios. It applies to every production renting Stages 1 to 6, the Green Room annex and the outdoor backlot known as Lotus Street. "Animal performer" means any live vertebrate brought onto studio grounds for filming, whether it appears on camera or is kept as a stand-in.

Insects and aquarium fish kept in sealed tanks of less than 60 litres are not covered by the full procedure. For these, the production only needs to notify the Animal Welfare Coordinator by email from the StudioDesk portal at least 2 working days before the shoot.

Version 2.1 replaces version 2.0 of March 2025. The main changes are a longer notice period for requests (Step 1), a lower temperature limit on enclosed stages (Step 3) and a new rule on night work (Step 4).

2. Step 1: Submit the Animal Performer Request (AP-1)

The production manager submits form AP-1 through the StudioDesk portal at least **10 working days** before the first shoot day that involves animals. Until 31 August 2026 the notice period was 7 working days. The form must list:

- the species, number, age and sex of every animal, including stand-ins;
- the name of the licensed animal agency and of each handler;
- the scenes, stages and planned hours for each animal on each day;
- any special effects planned near the animals, such as rain, haze, wind machines or blank-firing weapons.

Duangporn Thammachat, the studio's Animal Welfare Coordinator, reviews each AP-1 and replies within 3 working days with an approval, a request for changes or a refusal. On approval, the production pays an animal-use deposit of 10,000 baht per production, whatever the number of animals.

> **Late requests.** A request received less than 10 working days ahead can be reviewed on an expedited basis for a fee of 4,500 baht, but only if at least 5 working days remain before the first animal shoot day. Requests received with fewer than 5 working days to go are refused and the scenes must be rescheduled.

3. Step 2: Arrange handlers and veterinary checks

Every animal must arrive with a handler from a licensed agency, and the handler stays with the animal for the whole time it is on studio grounds. The minimum staffing levels are:

- dogs, cats and rabbits: one handler for every 2 animals;

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- horses, cattle and other large animals: one handler for each animal;
- birds: one handler for every 6 birds, and birds may only fly free on Stage 5, which has a closed net ceiling;

Each animal needs a health certificate signed by a veterinarian no more than 7 days before its first day at the studio. In addition, the studio's contract veterinarian, Dr. Pakorn Inthawong, examines the animals on arrival every shoot day in the Animal Holding Bay (Building C, Room C-04). The on-arrival check costs 1,500 baht per shoot day for up to five animals, plus 200 baht for each animal beyond the fifth. The fee is invoiced to the production with the stage rental.

4. Step 3: Prepare the stage and the Holding Bay

Book the Animal Holding Bay at the same time as the AP-1. The bay has six kennels and two stalls for large animals. Animals must rest there, not in vehicles or on the stage floor.

On enclosed stages the air temperature at floor level must stay at or below **30 °C** while animals are present (the limit was 32 °C under version 2.0). The stage electrician checks the reading every hour and records it on the stage log. On the Lotus Street backlot, all animal work stops when the shade temperature reaches 34 °C, and from 1 April to 31 May no animal may work outdoors between 12:00 and 15:00.

- Lay non-slip rubber mats on any polished or painted floor where animals walk.
- Tape down or cover all cables along animal walking routes.
- Switch off haze and smoke machines whenever an animal is on the stage.
- Move animals to the Holding Bay before any pyrotechnics are fired within 50 metres of them.
- Keep animals at least 30 metres from blank-firing weapons, and only with ear protection fitted by the handler.
- Post the red-and-white "Animal on Set" signs, collected from the stage office, on every stage door.

5. Step 4: Plan working hours and rest breaks

Time on set counts from when the animal leaves the Holding Bay until it returns. The daily limits are:

- Dogs and cats: up to 4 hours on set per day, with no more than 45 minutes in a row under lights, followed by at least 15 minutes of rest in the Holding Bay.
- Horses and cattle: up to 6 hours on set per day, with no more than 1 hour in a row, followed by at least 20 minutes of rest.
- Birds and rabbits: up to 3 hours on set per day, with no more than 30 minutes in a row.

Animals younger than 6 months, such as puppies and kittens, may work no more than 2 hours per day in total, whatever their species, and the veterinarian must be present on the stage for the whole time they are working.

No animal may work after 22:00. As an exception, night work up to 23:30 may be approved in the AP-1 for dogs and horses only, and on no more than two nights in any production week (Monday to Sunday). A third late night in the same week is not allowed, even if the scenes were approved in the AP-1.

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6. Step 5: Run the shoot day

Mark every scene with animals on the call sheet with the letters "AP" and the name of the handler. The handler briefs the director, the first assistant director and the camera team at least 30 minutes before the first animal shot. Before each take the first assistant director announces "animal on set", and from that moment no more than 12 crew members may stand within 5 metres of the animal.

The studio sends an independent Animal Safety Monitor to every shoot day with animals. The Monitor keeps the time log for each animal and has the authority to stop any take, or the whole animal shoot, if an animal shows signs of stress or a rule in this guide is broken. The decision of the Monitor cannot be overruled by the director or the producer. The Monitor costs 3,200 baht per 10-hour day, and each extra hour is charged at 400 baht.

> **Note.** Only the handler may give food rewards. Crew members must not feed, touch or call the animals.

7. Step 6: If an animal is hurt or distressed

1. Stop the take at once. The handler removes the animal from the set to the Holding Bay.
2. Call the Holding Bay on extension 2404. Outside office hours the security desk on extension 2000 contacts Dr. Pakorn Inthawong, who is on call during all animal shoot days.
3. The production manager files form AP-4 (Animal Incident Report) with the Animal Welfare Coordinator within **24 hours**, with the Monitor's time log attached.
4. An animal with any injury may not return to set until the veterinarian clears it in writing. The studio informs the animal agency the same day.

8. Step 7: Wrap and close the request

Animals must leave the stage within 30 minutes of the last animal shot of the day. Studio staff clean and disinfect the Holding Bay after each shoot day, for a cleaning fee of 900 baht per day. The production returns the "Animal on Set" signs to the stage office before the stage is handed back.

Within 3 working days of the last animal shoot day, the production manager submits form AP-5 (Animal Wrap Report), listing the actual hours worked by each animal. The 10,000-baht deposit is refunded within 14 days after the AP-5 is accepted, minus any cleaning, damage or late-wrap charges.

9. Arrivals and contacts

Vehicles carrying animals must enter through Gate 2 on the Phutthamonthon Sai 4 side, between 06:00 and 20:00 only, and park in the shaded bays next to Building C. Gate 1 is for crew and equipment trucks and may not be used for animal transport.

- Animal Welfare Coordinator: Duangporn Thammachat, extension 2410, Building A, Room A-112.
- Contract Studio Veterinarian: Dr. Pakorn Inthawong, through the Holding Bay, extension 2404.
- Stage office (signs, temperature logs, mats): extension 2300.

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